

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 585

By Warner

A RESOLUTION to honor the Tennessee Walking Horse Breeders' and Exhibitors' Association on the occasion of its ninetieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, in the 1860s, the smooth-riding horses used on farms in the American South began growing in popularity because of their calm disposition, smooth gaits, and sure-footedness; and

WHEREAS, possessing a unique four-beat gait, these "Tennessee Pacers" or "Southern Plantation Walking Horses" were becoming sought after not only in the South, but in other parts of the country, and the need to organize a breed registry was evident by 1935; and

WHEREAS, a street corner conversation in Lewisburg between former Governor Jim Nance McCord and Mr. Burt Hunter led to a public meeting in May 1935 for the purpose of organizing a breed association; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Walking Horse Breeders' Association of America (now the Tennessee Walking Horse Breeders' and Exhibitors' Association or TWHBEA) was established on May 11, 1935, in Lewisburg; Mr. Hunter was elected its first president and Governor McCord its first secretary-treasurer; and

WHEREAS, according to *Biography of the Tennessee Walking Horse* by Ben A. Green, the organization of TWHBEA in 1935 was "easily the most essential thing to happen in favor of the Tennessee Walking Horse," making possible the Tennessee Walking Horse National Celebration at Shelbyville; and

WHEREAS, in furtherance of its mission to "perpetuate the breed," TWHBEA started a registration program for the Tennessee Walking Horse; and

WHEREAS, the studbook was closed in 1947 with 114 selected Foundation Sires and Dams; the Tennessee Walking Horse was recognized as a breed by the federal government in 1950; and

WHEREAS, TWHBEA has now registered over half a million horses in all fifty states and thirty different countries and represents 6,521 members hailing from all fifty states and seventeen countries; and

WHEREAS, named for the State where the breed registry started, the Tennessee Walking Horse has brought fame to the Volunteer State from around the globe and was named the official State Horse of Tennessee in 2000; and

WHEREAS, versatility has always been a hallmark of Tennessee Walking Horses; their smooth gaits and equilibrium on our rocky terrain made them popular 160 years ago, and this all-purpose breed is still popular today; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee Walking Horses' flashy movement makes them stars in the showring, and the natural characteristics that have been passed down through selective breeding make them popular for trail riding and sought after as dependable mounts for field trials; and

WHEREAS, the modern Tennessee Walking Horse also excels in a variety of competitive disciplines, including dressage, competitive trail riding, extreme cowboy racing, barrel racing, pole bending, trail obstacle, and many more; and

WHEREAS, headquartered in Lewisburg since its inception, the TWHBEA of today is steadfast in its mission of registering, promoting, protecting, and preserving the Tennessee Walking Horse breed by serving as a leader in unifying the industry and providing value to the diverse interests of an international membership; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE

CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor the Tennessee Walking Horse Breeders' and Exhibitors' Association on the occasion of its ninetieth anniversary and thank the organization's leadership, employees, and volunteers for their ongoing commitment to the prosperity of the Tennessee Walking Horse breed and its owners, riders, and enthusiasts.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.